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United States Patent	12405116
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
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Navigation system with automatic optical calibration mechanism and method of operation thereof

Abstract

A navigation system includes: a control circuit configured to: a control circuit configured to: capture a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors, extract lane lines from the sensor data stream, optimize an extrinsic parameter and an intrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines, and compile optimized parameters including the extrinsic parameter and the intrinsic parameter; and a communication circuit, coupled to the control circuit, configured to receive an optical sensor alert for displaying on a device.

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Appl. No.:	18/117273
Filed:	March 03, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240295402 A1	Sep. 05, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06T7/80 (20170101); G01C21/30 (20060101); G06T7/70 (20170101); H04N17/00 (20060101); H04N23/90 (20230101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G01C21/30** (20130101); **G06T7/80** (20170101); **H04N17/002** (20130101); **H04N23/90** (20230101); G06T2207/20212 (20130101); G06T2207/30168 (20130101); G06T2207/30256 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04N (17/002); G06T (7/70); G06T (7/80); G06T (2007/20212); G06T (2007/30168); G06T (2007/30256)

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) An embodiment of the present invention relates generally to a navigation system, and more particularly to a system with an automatic optical calibration system.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) As autonomous vehicles emerge on the scene, they require detailed high definition maps that can display every aspect of a roadway along a route and an optical network that can verify features listed in the high definition maps. The optical network can consist of multiple cameras that observe all sides of the environment around the autonomous vehicle. The combination of the optical network and a high definition map are required for safe operation of the autonomous vehicle. Over time the condition of the optical network can degrade to the point that it is not advisable to use the vehicle in autonomous mode.

(3) Thus, a need still remains for a navigation system with an automatic optical calibration mechanism to provide monitoring and calibration of the optical network to improve identification of roadway features for autonomous vehicles. In view of the ever-increasing commercial competitive pressures, along with growing consumer expectations and the diminishing opportunities for meaningful product differentiation in the marketplace, it is increasingly critical that answers be found to these problems. Additionally, the need to reduce costs, improve efficiencies and performance, and meet competitive pressures adds an even greater urgency to the critical necessity for finding answers to these problems.

(4) Solutions to these problems have been long sought but prior developments have not taught or suggested any solutions and, thus, solutions to these problems have long eluded those skilled in the

art.

DISCLOSURE OF THE INVENTION

(5) An embodiment of the present invention provides a method of operation of a navigation system including capturing a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors: extracting lane lines from the sensor data stream: optimizing an intrinsic parameter and an extrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines: compiling optimized parameters including the intrinsic parameter and the extrinsic parameter: and receiving an optical sensor alert for displaying on a device.

(6) An embodiment of the present invention provides a navigation system, including a control circuit configured to: a control circuit configured to: capture a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors, extract lane lines from the sensor data stream, optimize an intrinsic parameter and an extrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines, and compile optimized parameters including the intrinsic parameter and the extrinsic parameter: and a communication circuit, coupled to the control circuit, configured to receive an optical sensor alert through the network for displaying on a device.

(7) An embodiment of the present invention provides a non-transitory computer readable medium including instructions for a navigation system, including: capturing a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors: extracting lane lines from the sensor data stream: optimizing an intrinsic parameter and an extrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines: compiling optimized parameters including the intrinsic parameter and the extrinsic parameter: and receiving an optical sensor alert for displaying on a device.

(8) Certain embodiments of the invention have other steps or elements in addition to or in place of those mentioned above. The steps or elements will become apparent to those skilled in the art from a reading of the following detailed description when taken with reference to the accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a navigation system with an automatic optical calibration mechanism in an embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is an example of a top plan view illustration of a vehicle for the navigation system.

(3) FIG. 3 is an exemplary projection view as processed by the navigation system.

(4) FIG. 4 is shown an exemplary analysis diagram of the navigation system.

(5) FIG. 5 is an exemplary block diagram of the navigation system in an embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is exemplary operational flow chart of the navigation system in an embodiment of the present invention.

(7) FIG. 7 is a flow chart of a method of operation of a navigation system in an embodiment of the present invention.

BEST MODE FOR CARRYING OUT THE INVENTION

(8) The features described, on an individual basis, can be executed in combination without altering the claimed invention. The description of the individual features is for clarity and understanding of the depth and breadth of the claimed invention, without limitation on the combination of those features. The execution of any combination of the features is possible.

(9) An optical network can consist of four cameras with fisheye lenses that are strategically placed to observe all sides of an autonomous vehicle. The functioning of these cameras is imperative to the safe operation of the autonomous vehicles. As these vehicles age, the extrinsic and intrinsic parameters can drift away from the original values. The changes could be the result of an oxidized lens, dirt or debris on the lens or housing of the camera, position changes on the body of the vehicle, or a combination of such elements. In order to address the real-time changes in the optical

network, an automatic optical calibration mechanism can dynamically tune the extrinsic and intrinsic parameters and alert the user that a parametric deficiency has been detected.

(10) The following embodiments are described in sufficient detail to enable those skilled in the art to make and use the invention. It is to be understood that other embodiments would be evident based on the present disclosure, and that system, process, or mechanical changes may be made without departing from the scope of an embodiment of the present invention.

(11) In the following description, numerous specific details are given to provide a thorough understanding of the invention. However, it will be apparent that the invention may be practiced without these specific details. In order to avoid obscuring an embodiment of the present invention, some well-known circuits, system configurations, and process steps are not disclosed in detail.

(12) The drawings showing embodiments of the system are semi-diagrammatic, and not to scale and, particularly, some of the dimensions are for the clarity of presentation and are shown exaggerated in the drawing figures. Similarly, although the views in the drawings for ease of description generally show similar orientations, this depiction in the figures is arbitrary for the most part. Generally, the invention can be operated in any orientation. The embodiments of various components as a matter of descriptive convenience and are not intended to have any other significance or provide limitations for an embodiment of the present invention.

(13) One skilled in the art would appreciate that the format with which navigation information is expressed is not critical to some embodiments of the invention. For example, in some embodiments, navigation information is presented in the format of (X, Y, Z): where X and Y and Z are three coordinates that define the geographic location, i.e., a position of a vehicle, an artifact, or a pixel in an optical data frame.

(14) The term “module” referred to herein can be implemented as or include software running on specialized hardware, hardware, or a combination thereof in the present invention in accordance with the context in which the term is used. For example, the software can be machine code, firmware, embedded code, and application software. The software can also include a function, a call to a function, a code block, or a combination thereof.

(15) Also, for example, the hardware can be gates, circuitry, processor, computer, integrated circuit, integrated circuit cores, memory devices, a pressure sensor, an inertial sensor, a microelectromechanical system (MEMS), passive devices, physical non-transitory memory medium including instructions for performing the software function, a portion therein, or a combination thereof to control one or more of the hardware units or circuits. Further, if a “unit” is written in the system claims section below; the “unit” is deemed to include hardware circuitry for the purposes and the scope of the system claims.

(16) The units in the following description of the embodiments can be coupled or attached to one another as described or as shown. The coupling or attachment can be direct or indirect without or with intervening items between coupled or attached modules or units. The coupling or attachment can be by physical contact or by communication between modules or units, such as wireless communication.

(17) The term “extrinsic parameter” as used in this description means the pose of the camera being analyzed. The pose of the camera defines the physical relationship between camera and the real world objects the camera is viewing. The variables used to analyze the pose are direction, pitch, and yaw. The term “intrinsic parameter” as used in this description means the physical parameters within the camera including the focal length, lens distortion coefficient, scaling factor, principal point location, and size of the pixels. The combination of the extrinsic parameters and the intrinsic parameters define the physical conversion of the real-world view to the corrected captured image within the camera.

(18) The term “fuse” or “fusing” as used in the specification and the claims have the meaning of combining, concatenating, merging, or integrating as appropriate for the usage of the term. In the case of the optical network, fusing the views of adjacent cameras can identify elements that are

displayed in more than one view from adjacent cameras.

(19) It is also understood that the nouns or elements in the embodiments can be described as a singular instance. It is understood that the usage of singular is not limited to singular but the singular usage can be applicable to multiple instances for any particular noun or element in the application. The numerous instances can be the same or similar or can be different.

(20) Referring now to FIG. 1, therein is shown a block diagram of a navigation system **100** with an automatic optical calibration mechanism in an embodiment of the present invention. The navigation system **100** can include a first device **102**, such as a client or a server, connected to a second device **106**, such as a client or server.

(21) The navigation system **100** can include a system for capturing detailed information about a road or thoroughfare based on fusion of multiple sources to reconcile and quickly identify specific details about the roadway surface and signage associated with traffic flow on the roadway. The first device **102** can communicate with the second device **106** through a network **104**, such as a wireless or wired network.

(22) For example, the first device **102** can be of any of a variety of computing devices, such as a cellular phone, personal digital assistant, a notebook computer, an autonomous vehicle, automotive telematics navigation system, or other multi-functional device. Also, for example, the first device **102** can include a device or a sub-system, an autonomous or self-maneuvering vehicle or object, a driver assisted vehicle, a remote-controlled vehicle or object, or a combination thereof.

(23) The first device **102** can couple, either directly or indirectly, to the network **104** to communicate with the second device **106** or can be a stand-alone device. The first device **102** can further be separate from or incorporated with a vehicle, such as a car, truck, bus, or motorcycle.

(24) For illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is described with the first device **102** as a mobile computing device, although it is understood that the first device **102** can be different types of devices. The first device **102** can be an autonomous vehicle or an accessory device coupled to the telematics vehicle network to support an autonomous vehicle.

(25) The second device **106** can be any of a variety of centralized or decentralized computing devices. For example, the second device **106** can be a computer, grid computing resources, a virtualized computer resource, cloud computing resource, routers, switches, peer-to-peer distributed computing devices, or a combination thereof.

(26) The second device **106** can be centralized in a single room, distributed across different rooms, distributed across different geographical locations, embedded within a telecommunications network. The second device **106** can couple with the network **104** to communicate with the first device **102**. The second device **106** can also be a client type device as described for the first device **102**.

(27) For illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is described with the second device **106** as a non-mobile computing device, although it is understood that the second device **106** can be different types of computing devices. For example, the second device **106** can also be a mobile computing device, such as notebook computer, another client device, a wearable device, or a different type of client device.

(28) Also, for illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is described with the second device **106** as a computing device, although it is understood that the second device **106** can be different types of devices. Also, for illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is shown with the second device **106** and the first device **102** as endpoints of the network **104**, although it is understood that the navigation system **100** can include a different partition between the first device **102**, the second device **106**, and the network **104**. For example, the first device **102**, the second device **106**, or a combination thereof can also function as part of the network **104**.

(29) The network **104** can span and represent a variety of networks. For example, the network **104** can include wireless communication, wired communication, optical, ultrasonic, or the combination thereof. Satellite communication, cellular communication, Bluetooth, Infrared Data Association

standard (IrDA), wireless fidelity (WiFi), and worldwide interoperability for microwave access (WiMAX) are examples of wireless communication that can be included in the communication path. Ethernet, digital subscriber line (DSL), fiber to the home (FTTH), and plain old telephone service (POTS) are examples of wired communication that can be included in the network **104**. Further, the network **104** can traverse a number of network topologies and distances. For example, the network **104** can include direct connection, personal area network (PAN), local area network (LAN), metropolitan area network (MAN), wide area network (WAN), or a combination thereof.

(30) The navigation system **100** can provide additional features that are not available in prior art navigation systems. The first device **102** can be coupled to optical sensors **108** that include a sensor data local storage **110**. The optical sensors **108** are monitoring devices, such as a set of monocular cameras positioned on the first device **102**, configured to monitor, observe, record, or a combination thereof the surroundings of the first device **102**. The sensor data local storage **110** provides a non-transitory storage medium loaded by a parameter extraction unit **112** to store a sensor data stream **111** captured by the optical sensors **108**. The parameter extraction unit **112** can be a hardware structure that provides machine learning and can include four banks of the memory that can be loaded from the sensor data stream **111** of the optical sensors **108** for manipulation of the sensor data stream **111** in order to identify the extrinsic and intrinsic parameters. The parameter extraction unit **112** can include circuitry that analyzes the overlap region from each of the optical sensors **108** to identify items or elements that appear in more than one of the optical sensors **108**.

(31) The parameter extraction unit **112** can be coupled to a global re-optimization unit **114**, in the sensor data local storage **110**, capable of storing fixed size frames from each of the optical sensors **108**, such as periodically captured the sensor data stream **111** can be analyzed by the global re-optimization unit **114** in succession. The global re-optimization unit **114** can be a hardware structure that receives the sensor data stream **111**. Once processed, the global re-optimization unit **114** can be serially correct the real-world position of lines and features in the sensor data stream **111**.

(32) For example, the sensor data local storage **110** can be implemented in a number of ways, such as a non-volatile storage device, such as a hard disk drive, a solid state storage device (SSD), a FLASH memory card, or a combination thereof capable of fusing the sensor data stream **111** from each of the optical sensors **108** into the global re-optimization unit **114**.

(33) The parameter extraction unit **112** can provide a pixel evaluation module, that can be implemented in software running of specialized hardware, full hardware, or a combination thereof configured to analyze a photographic scene to identify features and lane lines around the first device **102**. The data can include road markings, lane lines, road boundaries, traffic control devices, crosswalks, lane markers, or a combination thereof. The parameter extraction unit **112** can process a sensor data stream **111**, including sampled frames of data from each or the optical sensors **108**, in order to provide the global re-optimization unit **114** with relative locations of features based on the physical location of the optical sensors **108**.

(34) The global re-optimization unit **114** can process the sensor data stream **111** in order to estimate the geographic location of the lines and features in the sensor data stream **111**. An overhead view unit **116** can produce a two-dimensional overhead view of a roadway in a region surrounding the first device **102**. It is understood that the compilation of the sensor data stream **111** from four of the optical sensors **108** can be displayed by the overhead view unit **116**. The overhead view unit **116** is a hardware structure supported by software that can generate a view of the region surrounding the first device **102**. The overhead view unit **116** provides a fusing of the sensor data stream **111** from each of the optical sensors **108**, including resolving any overlap view of features that are observed in more than one of the optical sensors **108**. The overhead view unit **116** can provide position correction of features and elements that are duplicated in more than one of the sensor data stream **111**. It will be understood that wide angle lenses of the optical sensor **108** will provide overlap regions that observe the same objects from different angles. The overhead view unit **116** can correct

the pose error caused by these overlap regions during the fusing of the sensor data stream **111**.

(35) The sensor data local storage **110** can be coupled to or integrated with the optical sensors **108** in order to store a sensor data stream **111** from each of the optical sensors **108** available in the first device **102**. The first device **102** can access the parameter extraction unit **112** to determine the relative performance of the optical sensors **108**. If the parameter extraction unit **112** determines that the performance of the optical sensors **108** is impaired, a message can be displayed to a user **118**.

(36) The navigation system **100** can be operated without the user **118**. The user **118** can include a person or an entity accessing or utilizing the navigation system **100** or a device therein. For example, the user **118** can include a person owning or operating the first device **102**, a service, or a combination thereof. Also, for example, the user **118** can access or utilize the second device **106** through the first device **102**, a service, or a combination thereof.

(37) The navigation system **100** can further process a direct user input **119** from the user **118**. The direct user input **119** can include the user **118** taking manual control of the autonomous vehicle or the first device **102**. The direct user input **119** can be provided by or from the user **118** directly to or directly on the first device **102**.

(38) The direct user input **119** can include an increase in speed, a decrease in speed, a change of position within a lane, stop, start, or changing lanes as prompted or controlled by the user **118**. The direct user input **119** can include the user **118** issuing audio commands or physically managing the manual controls within the first device **102**.

(39) The second device **106** can receive optimized parameters **120**, periodically from the first device **102**, to track a population of the optical sensors **108** used in the first device **102**. The second device **106** compile the optimized parameters **120** from a population of the first device **102**. By performing a trend analysis of the optimized parameters **120**, the second device can use an artificial intelligence algorithm to predict when the optical sensors must be serviced before they present a dangerous situation.

(40) The combination of processing provided by the first device **102** and the second device **106** can alert the user **118** that the optical sensors are in need of maintenance. In extreme cases, the second device **106** can alert the first device **102** to have the user take control of the first device, such as an autonomous vehicle.

(41) It is understood that while the embodiment described above requires the processing power of the first device **102** and the second device **106**, but it is understood that the full operation of the navigation system **100** can be performed within the first device **102**. Other partitions of the invention are possible and would be understood by one having ordinary skill in the art.

(42) It has been discovered that the navigation system **100** can reliably maintain the optimized parameters **120** for the first device **102** without intervention by the user **118**. In the autonomous vehicle, maintaining the proper control of the optimized parameters **120** is key to the safe operation and can provide early warning that the optical sensors **108** require attention. The navigation system **100** can improve the reliability of the autonomous vehicle by providing the optimized parameters **120** and the early warning to the user **118** that maintenance is required. The optical sensors **108** of the optical network can be repositioned due to vibration, accident, or manual interference. In other cases, the lens of one or more of the optical sensors **108** can be soiled or blocked by debris. A first device **102** operating in autonomous mode can become a lethal weapon if one or more of the optical sensors **108** in the optical network is damaged or degraded.

(43) Referring now to FIG. 2, therein is shown an example of a top plan view **201** illustration of a vehicle for the navigation system **100** of FIG. 1. The navigation system **100** can be included in or interact with the first device **102**. Since the set-up and calibration of the optical network is performed by a specific process when the autonomous vehicle is first manufactured. The degradation of the optical network must be periodically verified by the manufacturer during scheduled maintenance. The possible degradation of the optical network between scheduled maintenance can present significant dangers to the passengers and the public.

(44) The first device **102** can be an object or a machine used for transporting people or goods capable of automatically maneuvering or operating the object or the machine. The first device **102** can include vehicles accessible by the user **118** of FIG. **1** for control, maneuver, operation, or a combination thereof. For example, the first device **102** can include a car, a truck, a cart, a drone, or a combination thereof.

(45) The first device **102** can further be controlled or maneuvered without the direct user input **119** of FIG. **1** corresponding to the maneuver or the movement. For example, the first device **102** can include a self-driving vehicle, or a vehicle with automatic maneuvering features, such as smart cruise control or preventative breaking. The first device **102** can include a smart cruise control feature, capable of setting and adjusting the travel speed of the first device **102** without the direct user input **119**. Also, for example, the first device **102** can be controlled or maneuvered by the navigation system **100**, including the navigation system **100** controlling or setting a cruising speed, lane position, or other physical maneuvers or movements of the first device **102**.

(46) The navigation system **100** can further utilize the optimized parameters **120** from one or more vehicles or devices. The optimized parameters **120** can provide important reliability information and adjustments for a front optical sensor **220**, a rear optical sensor **222**, a left optical sensor **224**, and a right optical sensor **226**. Each of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** can be a hardware camera including a fisheye lens having a 170 degree view of a region of interest **203**.

(47) The first device **102** or other vehicles interfacing with the navigation system **100** can include a device, a circuit, one or more specific sensors, such as environmental sensors **210**, or a combination thereof for providing assistance or additional information to the user **118** controlling, maneuvering, or operating the first device **102**. The environmental sensors **210** can include a cabin camera, LiDAR sensors, the optical sensors **108**, or a combination thereof. The optical sensors **108** can be camera with a wide-angle lens, such as a fisheye lens. The optical sensors **108** can be mounted on the exterior of the first device **102** positioned at the front, rear, left side, and right side of the first device **102**. The first device **102** or any other vehicles can include a vehicle communication circuit **204**, a vehicle control circuit **206**, a vehicle storage circuit **208**, other interfaces, or a combination thereof.

(48) The vehicle storage circuit **208** can include a functional unit or circuit integral to the corresponding first device **102** and configured to store and recall information. The vehicle storage circuit **208** can be a volatile memory, a nonvolatile memory, an internal memory, an external memory, or a combination thereof and can include the sensor local storage **110** of FIG. **1**. For example, the vehicle storage circuit **208** can be a nonvolatile storage such as non-volatile random access memory (NVRAM), Flash memory, disk storage, or a volatile storage such as static random access memory (SRAM).

(49) The vehicle storage circuit **208** can store vehicle software, other relevant data, such as input information, information from sensors, processing results, information predetermined or preloaded by the navigation system **100** or vehicle manufacturer, or a combination thereof. The vehicle storage circuit **208** can periodically load the optimized parameters **120** from the second device **106** of FIG. **1** for the optical sensors **108**.

(50) The vehicle control circuit **206** can include a functional unit or circuit integral to the first device **102** and configured as a processor to execute or implement instructions. The vehicle control circuit **206** can execute or implement the vehicle software to provide the intelligence of the corresponding vehicle, the navigation system **100**, or a combination thereof.

(51) The vehicle control circuit **206** can be implemented in a number of different manners. For example, the vehicle control circuit **206** can be a processor, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC) an embedded processor, a microprocessor, a hardware control logic, a hardware finite state machine (FSM), a digital signal processor (DSP), or a combination thereof. As a more specific example, the vehicle control circuit **206** can include an engine control unit, one or more

central processing unit, or a combination thereof

(52) The vehicle communication circuit **204** can include a functional unit or circuit integral to the corresponding vehicle, such as the first device **102**, another vehicle, or a combination thereof. The vehicle communication circuit **204** can be configured to enable external communication to and from the corresponding vehicle. For example, the vehicle communication circuit **204** can permit the first device **102** to communicate with the second device **106** through the network **104** of FIG. **1**.

(53) The vehicle communication circuit **204** can also function as a communication hub allowing the corresponding control vehicle to function as part of the network **104** and not limited to be an end point or terminal circuit to the network **104**. The vehicle communication circuit **204** can include active and passive components, such as microelectronics, circuitry, or an antenna, for interaction with the network **104**. For example, the vehicle communication circuit **204** can include a modem, a transmitter, a receiver, a port, a connector, or a combination thereof for wired communication, wireless communication, or a combination thereof.

(54) The vehicle communication circuit **204** can couple with the network **104** to send or receive information directly between the vehicle communication circuit **204** and the second device **106** as end points of the communication, such as for direct line-of-sight communication or peer-to-peer communication. The vehicle communication circuit **204** can further couple with the network **104** to send or receive information through a server or another intermediate device in between endpoints of the communication.

(55) The first device **102** or other vehicles can further include various interfaces. The first device **102** can include one or more interfaces for interaction or internal communication between functional units or circuits of the first device **102**. For example, the first device **102** can include one or more interfaces, such as drivers, firmware, wire connections or buses, protocols, or a combination thereof, for the vehicle storage circuit **208**, the vehicle control circuit **206**, or a combination thereof.

(56) The first device **102** or the other vehicles can further include one or more interfaces for interaction with an occupant, an operator or a passenger, the user **118**, or a combination thereof relative to the corresponding vehicle. For example, the first device **102** or the other vehicles can include a user interface **212** including input or output devices or circuits, such as a screen or touch screen, a speaker, a microphone, a keyboard or other input devices, an instrument panel, or a combination thereof.

(57) The first device **102** can further include one or more interfaces along with switches or actuators for physically controlling movable components of the first device **102**. For example, the first device **102** can include the one or more interfaces along with the controlling mechanisms to physically perform and control the maneuvering of the first device **102**, such as for automatic driving, smart cruise control, or maneuvering features.

(58) The functional units or circuits in the first device **102** can work individually and independently of the other functional units or circuits. The first device **102** can work individually and independently from the network **104**, the second device **106**, other devices or vehicles, or a combination thereof.

(59) The functional units or circuits described above can be implemented in hardware. For example, one or more of the functional units or circuits can be implemented using a gate, circuitry, a processor, a computer, integrated circuit, integrated circuit cores, a pressure sensor, an inertial sensor, a microelectromechanical system (MEMS), a passive device, a physical non-transitory memory medium containing instructions for performing the software function, a portion therein, or a combination thereof.

(60) The environmental sensors **210** are each a device or a circuit for detecting or identifying environment of the corresponding vehicle. The environmental sensors **210** can detect, identify, determine, or a combination thereof, such as for status, surroundings or movement for the corresponding vehicle. The environmental sensors **210** can detect, identify, determine, or a

combination thereof for environment within a cabin of the corresponding vehicle, an environment external to and surrounding the corresponding vehicle, or a combination thereof. The environmental sensors **210** can be implement for the first device **102**.

(61) For example, the environmental sensors **210** can include a user interface **212**, the optical sensor **108**, a radar sensor **216**, a location-movement sensor **218**, or a combination thereof. The user interface **212** can include a projector, a video screen, a touch screen, a speaker, or any combination thereof. The user interface **212** can display the optimized parameters **120** of FIG. **1**, a planned route, lane suggestions, speed warnings, vehicle system alerts and combinations thereof.

(62) The optical sensor **108** can include a sensor for detecting or determining visual information representing the environment external to and surrounding of the corresponding vehicle. The optical sensor **108** can include a camera attached to or integral with the corresponding vehicle or device. For example, the optical sensor **108** can include a camera, such as forward facing camera, a video camera, a rear-view or back-up camera, a side-view or a blind-spot camera, or a combination thereof. Also, for example, the environmental sensors **210** can include an infrared sensor, a night vision video camera, or a night vision sensor.

(63) The optical sensor **108** can further include a camera on the first device **102** or another user device of the user **118** connected to and interacting with a vehicle. The optical sensor **108** can further include a cabin camera for detecting or determining visual information inside the vehicle or cabin of the vehicle.

(64) The radar sensor **216** can include an object-detection system, device, or circuit. The radar sensor **216** can determine or identify an existence of an object or a target, such as an obstacle or another vehicle, external to the corresponding device or vehicle, a relative location or a distance between the object or the target and the corresponding device or vehicle, or a combination thereof.

(65) The radar sensor **216** can utilize radio waves to determine or identify an existence of the object or the target, the relative location or a distance relative to the first device **102** or other corresponding device or vehicle, or a combination thereof. For example, the radar sensor **216** can include a proximity sensor or warning system, such as for an area in front of, behind, adjacent to or on a side of, or a combination thereof geographically or physically relative to the first device **102**.

(66) The location-movement sensor **218** can be a sensor for identifying or calculating a geographic location of the corresponding vehicle or device, determining a movement or speed of the corresponding vehicle or device, or a combination thereof. The location-movement sensor **218** can include an accelerometer, a speedometer, a Global Positioning System (GPS) receiver or device, a gyroscope or a compass, or a combination thereof. The first device **102** can include the environmental sensors **210** other than or in addition to the location-movement sensor **218**. The location-movement sensor **218** can provide a gyroscope rate of change for monitoring turns and a speed from the speedometer.

(67) The navigation system **100** can use one or more of the optical sensors **108** corresponding to one or more devices, one or more vehicles, or a combination thereof to generate the traffic flow state **109** describing or representing information regarding the environment surrounding the corresponding device or vehicle. The sensor data stream **111** of FIG. **1** can be further processed with the vehicle control circuit **206**, stored in the vehicle storage circuit **208**, communicated to another device or vehicle through the vehicle communication circuit **204**, or a combination thereof.

(68) As a more specific example, the vehicle communication circuit **204**, the vehicle control circuit **206**, the vehicle storage circuit **208**, the optical sensors **108**, one or more interfaces, or a combination thereof can be included in or make up the first device **102**.

(69) The navigation system **100** can provide the vehicle movement control **228** as a suggestion to the user **118** for maneuvering or operating the first device **102**. Details regarding the utilization and processing of the global re-optimization unit **114** are discussed below.

(70) The navigation system **100** can process and generate vehicle movement control **228** for controlling or maneuvering the first device **102**. The vehicle movement control **228** is an

instruction, a signal, a process, a method, a mechanism, or a combination thereof directing or controlling physical movement or travel of the first device **102**.

(71) Continuing with the example, the navigation system **100** can use the global re-optimization unit **114** provided from the first device **102** without the user input **119**. The navigation system **100** can utilize the global re-optimization unit **114** to provide information, assist maneuvering, control maneuvers, or a combination thereof for other vehicles near the first device **102**.

(72) Continuing with the example, the navigation system **100** can communicate the optimized parameters **120** through the second device **106** to other devices or vehicles, or directly communicate to the other devices or vehicles, such as for a peer-to-peer communication system. The navigation system **100** can communicate the optimized parameters **120** for informing other devices or vehicles of the status of the first device **102** itself, about other vehicles detected and identified around the first device **102**, or a combination thereof.

(73) As a more specific example, the navigation system **100** can use the optimized parameters **120** to detect weaknesses in the optical sensor **108** that would prevent the safe operation of the vehicle movement control **228**, such as for steering, braking, setting or adjusting travel speed, accessory control, or a combination thereof. Details regarding the processing of the vehicle movement control **228** are discussed below.

(74) It is understood that the optical sensors **108** can be positioned at fixed locations around the first device **102**. By way of an example, the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left side optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** can monitor the region of interest **203** including the details of the roadway **202**. The combination of the sensor data streams **111** of FIG. **1** from each of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left side optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** can be fused by the overhead view unit **116** of FIG. **1** to form surrounding view of the region of interest **203**.

(75) It is understood that due to the characteristics of the wide-angle lenses and the relative position of the optical sensors **108**, objects can appear in more than one of the optical data streams **111**. By way of an example, a fisheye viewing angle **230** can generate overlap regions **232** at the four corners of the region of interest **203**. It is understood that the fisheye viewing angle **230** can be substantially equal to 170 degrees of view. The resulting ones of the overlap region **232** can be resolved by the overhead view unit **116**. By way of an example, a traffic control sign **234** can be viewed by both the front optical sensor **220** and the right optical sensor **226**. The overhead view unit **116** can resolve the traffic control signal **234** to be a single unit of the traffic control sign **234** adjacent to the roadway **202**.

(76) Referring now to FIG. **3**, therein is shown an exemplary projection view **301** as processed by the navigation system **100**. The region of interest **203** can be represented by a world plane **302** that is the area viewed by a camera **304**. The camera **304** can be a high mega-pixel camera having a fisheye lens **306**. The fisheye lens **306** can provide a wide-angle view that can provide a first vanishing point **308** and a second vanishing point **310**. The geometry of the first vanishing point **308** and the second vanishing point **310** can be indicative of the distortion of the fisheye lens **306**.

(77) A projected view **312** of the region of interest **203** can be shown on an image plane **314**. The projected image **312** can be identified by extending a first vector **316** from the horizontal dimension of the projected image **312** to the first vanishing point **308** and extending a second vector **318** from the vertical dimension of the projected view **312** to the second vanishing point **310**. The resulting view of the projected image **312** can include the distortion coefficient caused by the fisheye lens **306**.

(78) A principal point **320** can represent the center and undistorted point in the image plane **314**. As the distance from the principal point **320** increases in all directions, the amount of distortion also increases. By assuming a specific relationship between lines extracted from the region of interest **203**, the distortion coefficient can be determined. It is understood that most of the intrinsic parameters of the camera **304** are fixed at the time of manufacture. The distortion coefficient can be

a variable based on the condition of the fisheye lens **306**.

(79) The global re-optimization unit **114** of FIG. **1** can capture the real world location, such as a GPS location, of the first device **102** when the optical data stream **111** is captured. The global re-optimization unit **114** can identify the relative location of features and lines in the optical data stream **111** for the front optical sensor **220** of FIG. **2**, the rear optical sensor **222** of FIG. **2**, the left optical sensor **224** of FIG. **2**, and the right optical sensor **226** of FIG. **2**. The overhead view unit **116** can fuse the optical data stream **111** from the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** into an overhead view with the overlap regions **232** of FIG. **2** resolved so that features that appear in more than one of the optical data stream **111** are displayed as a single feature in its actual location.

(80) The characteristic of the fisheye lens **306** of the optical sensors **108** provides greater distortion at greater angles from the perpendicular to the lens of the optical sensors **108**. The fisheye viewing angle **230** can provide a large capture area, but it also has increased distortion at the edges. It is understood that fisheye viewing angle **230** can be different for each of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226**, but the fisheye viewing angle **230** is constant for each of the optical sensors **108** of FIG. **1**.

(81) In order to identify the actual location of the lane lines around the first device **102** in the projection view **301**, a calculation of the distance between the lane lines from the front optical sensor **220** and the lane line in the view from the left optical sensor **224**. The projection view **301** can be an overhead view showing the relationship between the lane lines and the first device **102**. The distance between the lane lines of the front optical sensor **220** and the lane lines from the left optical sensor **224**, in the projection view **301**, can be measured in pixels. By applying a corrective measure, the lane lines can be shown to be parallel and, in some cases, contiguous.

(82) A similar calculation can be performed between the lane lines of the rear optical sensor **222** and the right optical sensor **226**. By adjusting the projected view **301**, the lane lines detected by the left optical sensor **224** and the right optical sensor **226** can be shown to be parallel with the lane lines from the front optical sensor **220** and the rear optical sensor **222**.

(83) It has been discovered that the parameter extraction unit **112** can learn the correction factors including the correction for the lane lines through training and everyday use. The correction distance, measured in pixels, can be provided to the overhead view unit **116** of FIG. **1** for quick display of the projection view **301**.

(84) Referring now to FIG. **4**, therein is shown an exemplary analysis diagram **401** of the navigation system **100** of FIG. **1**. The exemplary analysis diagram **401** depicts the region of interest **203** in a line extraction and parametric analysis process. The view of the region of interest **203** can be processed by the parameter extraction unit **112** applying machine learning to extract edge lines from the optical data stream **111** of FIG. **1**. The machine learning analysis of the parameter extraction unit **112** can identify a lane line **402**, such as a longitudinal line, a horizontal line **404**, such as a store front window top and bottom, and vertical lines **406**, such as edges of buildings, by observing a series of pixels forming the lines.

(85) It is understood that the optical data stream **111** will show the effects of the distortion coefficient on the lane lines **402**, the horizontal lines **404**, and the vertical lines **406**. The navigation system **100** is aware that the lane lines **402** are in a horizontal plane and parallel to each other. This information allows the determination of the distortion coefficient for the fisheye lens **306** of FIG. **3**.

(86) A first set of vanishing points **408** can include the points **V11** and **V12** in the horizontal direction. A second set of vanishing points **410** can include the points **V21** and **V22** in the vertical direction. The principal point **320** can be located at the intersection of the lines connecting the first set of vanishing points **408** and the second set of vanishing points **410**. As the distance from the principal point **320** increases, lines that are straight in the world plane **302** of FIG. **3** become curved lines due to the distortion of the fisheye lens **306**.

(87) The global re-optimization unit **114** of FIG. **1** can identify the relative location of the lines and

features captured from the optical data stream **111**. The amount of curvature and the distance from the principal point **320** can define a distortion coefficient **412** for the optical data stream **111**. The distortion coefficient **412** can be critical to the generation of an overhead view **414** and a view center **415**. The view center **415** can be the geolocation of the first device **102**. The distortion coefficient **412** can be degraded by dirt or debris on the housing of the optical sensor **108** or oxidation of the fisheye lens **306** of FIG. 3. The navigation system **100** can monitor the distortion coefficient **412** for the front optical sensor **220** of FIG. 2, the rear optical sensor **222** of FIG. 2, the left optical sensor **224** of FIG. 2, and the right optical sensor **226** of FIG. 2 in order to detect any degradation that would require maintenance of the optical sensors **108** or restriction to manual operation of the first device **102** of FIG. 2.

(88) The global re-optimization unit **114** can calculate the optimized parameters **120** by optimizing extrinsic parameters **418** and intrinsic parameters **420** for each of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226**. By way of an example, in computing the extrinsic parameters **418** of the left optical sensor **224** and the right optical sensor **226** and the global re-optimization unit **114** processing can converge the view of the left optical sensor **224** and the rear optical sensor **222**. In this example, the calculation of the extrinsic parameters **418** can be performed by analyzing the lane lines **402** in the image from the left optical sensor **224**, after converting to the overhead view **414**. The first device **102** can calculate the distance between the lane lines **402** in the image of the front optical sensor **220** and the lane lines **402** in the image of the left optical sensor **224** in the overhead view **414**. The first device **102** can calculate a distance, in the overhead view **414**, between the lane lines **402** of the left optical sensor **224** and the lane lines **402** of the rear optical sensor **222** in the same way. The distance between lane line ends **403** in the overhead view **414** is measured in pixels. The global re-optimization unit **114** can transform the location of the lane line ends **403** to a corrected position with a geolocation in the overhead view **414** based on the geolocation of the view center **415**.

(89) It has been discovered that the navigation system **100** can improve the reliability and safety of the first device **102**, such as an autonomous vehicle, by monitoring the distortion coefficient **412**. The first device **102** can display an optical sensor alert **416** to the user **118** of FIG. 1 to notify the user **118** that maintenance or manual operation is required. The navigation system **100** can prevent accidents that would be caused by degraded operation of the optical sensors **108**. Since the degraded operation of the optical sensors **108** can occur at any time, the optical sensor alert **416** can be an essential safety mechanism for the first device **102**.

(90) Referring now to FIG. 5, therein is shown an exemplary block diagram of the navigation system **100** in an embodiment. The navigation system **100** can include the first device **102**, the network **104**, and the second device **106**. The first device **102** can send information in a first device transmission **508** over the network **104** to the second device **106**. The second device **106** can send information in a second device transmission **510** over the network **104** to the first device **102**.

(91) For illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is shown with the first device **102** as a client device, although it is understood that the navigation system **100** can include the first device **102** as a different type of device. For example, the first device **102** can be a server containing the first display interface **530** coupled to the user interface **212**.

(92) Also, for illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is shown with the second device **106** as a server, although it is understood that the navigation system **100** can include the second device **106** as a different type of device. For example, the second device **106** can be a client device. By way of an example, the navigation system **100** can be implemented entirely on the first device **102**. The second device **106** can provide additional computing speed and power.

(93) Also, for illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is shown with interaction between the first device **102** and the second device **106**. However, it is understood that the first device **102** can be a part of or the entirety of an autonomous vehicle, a smart vehicle, or a combination thereof. Similarly, the second device **106** can similarly interact with the first device **102** representing the

autonomous vehicle, the intelligent vehicle, or a combination thereof.

(94) For brevity of description in this embodiment of the present invention, the first device **102** will be described as a client device and the second device **106** will be described as a server device. The embodiment of the present invention is not limited to this selection for the type of devices. The selection is an example of an embodiment of the present invention.

(95) The first device **102** can include a first control circuit **512**, a first storage circuit **514**, a first communication circuit **516**, a first interface circuit **518**, and a first location circuit **520**. The first control circuit **512** can include a first control interface **522**. The first control circuit **512** can execute a first software **526** to provide the intelligence of the navigation system **100**.

(96) The first control circuit **512** can be implemented in a number of different manners. For example, the first control circuit **512** can be a processor, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC) an embedded processor, a microprocessor, a hardware control logic, a hardware finite state machine (FSM), a digital signal processor (DSP), or a combination thereof. The first control interface **522** can be used for communication between the first control circuit **512** and other functional units or circuits in the first device **102**. The first control interface **522** can also be used for communication that is external to the first device **102**.

(97) The first control interface **522** can receive information from the other functional units/circuits or from external sources, or can transmit information to the other functional units/circuits or to external destinations. The external sources and the external destinations refer to sources and destinations external to the first device **102**.

(98) The first control interface **522** can be implemented in different ways and can include different implementations depending on which functional units/circuits or external units/circuits are being interfaced with the first control interface **522**. For example, the first control interface **522** can be implemented with a pressure sensor, an inertial sensor, a microelectromechanical system (MEMS), optical circuitry, waveguides, wireless circuitry, wireline circuitry, analogue circuitry, or a combination thereof.

(99) The first storage circuit **514** can store the first software **526**. The first storage circuit **514** can also store the relevant information, such as data representing incoming images, data representing previously presented image, sound files, or a combination thereof.

(100) The first storage circuit **514** can be a volatile memory, a nonvolatile memory, an internal memory, an external memory, or a combination thereof. For example, the first storage circuit **514** can be a nonvolatile storage such as non-volatile random-access memory (NVRAM), Flash memory, disk storage, or a volatile storage such as static random-access memory (SRAM).

(101) The first storage circuit **514** can include a first storage interface **524**. The first storage interface **524** can be used for communication between the first storage circuit **514** and other functional units or circuits in the first device **102**, such as the sensor data local storage **110** of FIG. **1**. The first storage interface **524** can also be used for communication that is external to the first device **102**.

(102) The first storage interface **524** can be a hardware circuitry configured to receive information from the other functional units/circuits or from external sources, or can transmit information to the other functional units/circuits or to external destinations. The external sources and the external destinations refer to sources and destinations external to the first device **102**. The first storage interface **524** can receive input from and source data to the map data module **115**.

(103) The first storage interface **524** can include different implementations depending on which functional units/circuits or external units/circuits are being interfaced with the first storage circuit **514**. The first storage interface **524** can be implemented with technologies and techniques similar to the implementation of the first control interface **522**, such as analogue circuitry, digital circuitry, wireless circuitry, or wireline circuitry.

(104) The first communication circuit **516** can enable external communication to and from the first device **102**. For example, the first communication circuit **516** can permit the first device **102** to

communicate with the second device **106** and the network **104**.

(105) The first communication circuit **516** can also function as a communication hub allowing the first device **102** to function as part of the network **104** and not limited to be an endpoint or terminal circuit to the network **104**. The first communication circuit **516** can include active and passive components, such as microelectronics, analogue circuitry, wireless circuitry, wireline circuitry, or an antenna, for interaction with the network **104**.

(106) The first communication circuit **516** can include a first communication interface **528**. The first communication interface **528** can be used for communication between the first communication circuit **516** and other functional units or circuits in the first device **102**. The first communication interface **528** can receive information from the second device **106** for distribution to the other functional units/circuits or can transmit information to the other functional units or circuits.

(107) The first communication interface **528** can include different implementations depending on which functional units or circuits are being interfaced with the first communication circuit **516**. The first communication interface **528** can be implemented with technologies and techniques similar to the implementation of the first control interface **522**, including a microelectromechanical system (MEMS), optical circuitry, waveguides, wireless circuitry, wireline circuitry, analogue circuitry, or a combination thereof.

(108) The first interface circuit **518** allows the user **118** of FIG. **1** to interface and interact with the first device **102**. The first interface circuit **518** can include an input device and an output device. Examples of the input device of the first interface circuit **518** can include a keypad, a touchpad, soft-keys, a keyboard, a microphone, an infrared sensor for receiving remote signals, the optical sensor **108**, or any combination thereof to provide data and communication inputs. By way of an example, the optical sensor **108** can connect to the first interface circuit **518** through a wired or wireless connection. The first interface circuit **518** can pass the input from the optical sensor **108** to the first control circuit **512** for processing and storage.

(109) The first interface circuit **518** can include a first display interface **530**. The first display interface **530** can include an output device. The first display interface **530** can couple the user interface **212** including a projector, a video screen, a touch screen, a speaker, a microphone, a keyboard, and combinations thereof. The user interface **212** can include the optical sensor alert **416** to notify the user **118** of FIG. **1** that a dangerous condition is in effect and maintenance or manual operation is required.

(110) The first control circuit **512** can operate the first interface circuit **518** to display the optical sensor alert **416** generated by the navigation system **100** and receive input from the user **118**. The first control circuit **512** can also execute the first software **526** for the other functions of the navigation system **100**, including receiving location information from the first location circuit **520**. The first control circuit **512** can further execute the first software **526** for interaction with the network **104** via the first communication circuit **516**.

(111) The first control circuit **512** can operate the first interface circuit **518** to collect the sensor data stream **111** from the optical sensors **108**. The first control circuit **512** can also receive location information from the first location circuit **520**. The first control circuit **512** can operate the parameter extraction unit **112** of FIG. **1** in order to provide the global re-optimization unit **114** with the indicators for the overlap regions **232** of FIG. **2** for further processing.

(112) The first location circuit **520** can be a hardware circuit configured to generate location information used to identify the view center **415** of FIG. **4** in real world coordinates, such as GPS coordinates. The view center **415** can be defined as the geolocation of the first device **102** as determined by the location circuit **520**. The first location circuit **520** can be implemented in many ways. For example, the first location circuit **520** can function as at least a part of the global positioning system, an inertial navigation system, a cellular-tower location system, a gyroscope, or any combination thereof. Also, for example, the first location circuit **520** can utilize components such as an accelerometer, gyroscope, or global positioning system (GPS) receiver in order to

identify the current location on the Earth by satellite triangulation of cell tower triangulation, including calculating pseudo ranges to the satellites or the cell towers.

(113) The first location circuit **520** can include a first location interface **532**. The first location interface **532** can be used for communication between the first location circuit **520** and other functional units or circuits in the first device **102**, including the optical sensor **108**.

(114) The first location interface **532** can receive information from the other functional units/circuits or from external sources, or can transmit information to the other functional units/circuits or to external destinations. The external sources and the external destinations refer to sources and destinations external to the first device **102**, including satellites and cell towers.

(115) The first location interface **532** can include different implementations depending on which functional units/circuits or external units/circuits are being interfaced with the first location circuit **520**. The first location interface **532** can be implemented with technologies and techniques similar to the implementation of the first control circuit **512**, including analogue circuitry, digital circuitry, wireless circuitry, or wireline circuitry.

(116) The second device **106** can be optimized for implementing an embodiment of the present invention in a multiple device embodiment with the first device **102**. The second device **106** can provide the additional or higher performance processing power compared to the first device **102**. The second device **106** can include a second control circuit **534**, a second communication circuit **536**, a second user interface **538**, and a second storage circuit **546**.

(117) The second user interface **538** allows an operator (not shown) to interface and interact with the second device **106**. The second user interface **538** can include an input device and an output device. Examples of the input device of the second user interface **538** can include a keypad, a touchpad, soft-keys, a keyboard, a microphone, or any combination thereof to provide data and communication inputs. Examples of the output device of the second user interface **538** can include a second display interface **540**. The second display interface **540** can include a display, a projector, a video screen, a speaker, or any combination thereof.

(118) The second control circuit **534** can receive the optimized parameters **120** through the second communication circuit **536**. The second control circuit **536** can analyze the optimized parameters **120** in order to determine thresholds and distribute warnings regarding the calibration of the optical sensors **108** transmitted by the first device **102**.

(119) The second control circuit **534** can execute a second software **542** to provide the intelligence of the second device **106** of the navigation system **100**. The second software **542** can operate in conjunction with the first software **526**. The second control circuit **534** can provide additional performance compared to the first control circuit **512**.

(120) The second control circuit **534** can operate the second user interface **538** to display information. The second control circuit **534** can also execute the second software **542** for the other functions of the navigation system **100**, including operating the second communication circuit **536** to communicate with the first device **102** over the network **104**.

(121) The second control circuit **534** can be implemented in a number of different manners. For example, the second control circuit **534** can be a processor, an embedded processor, a microprocessor, hardware control logic, a hardware finite state machine (FSM), a digital signal processor (DSP), or a combination thereof.

(122) The second control circuit **534** can include a second control interface **544**. The second control interface **544** can be used for communication between the second control circuit **534** and other functional units or circuits in the second device **106**. The second control interface **544** can also be used for communication that is external to the second device **106**.

(123) The second control interface **544** can receive information from the other functional units/circuits or from external sources, or can transmit information to the other functional units/circuits or to external destinations. The external sources and the external destinations refer to sources and destinations external to the second device **106**.

(124) The second control interface **544** can be implemented in different ways and can include different implementations depending on which functional units/circuits or external units/circuits are being interfaced with the second control interface **544**. For example, the second control interface **544** can be implemented with a pressure sensor, an inertial sensor, a microelectromechanical system (MEMS), optical circuitry, waveguides, wireless circuitry, wireline circuitry, analogue circuitry, or a combination thereof.

(125) The second storage circuit **546** can store the second software **542**. The second storage circuit **546** can also store the information such as the optimized parameters **120** transferred from the first device **102**. The second storage circuit **546** can be sized to provide the additional storage capacity to supplement the first storage circuit **514**.

(126) For illustrative purposes, the second storage circuit **546** is shown as a single element, although it is understood that the second storage circuit **546** can be a distribution of storage elements. Also, for illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is shown with the second storage circuit **546** as a single hierarchy storage system, although it is understood that the navigation system **100** can include the second storage circuit **546** in a different configuration. For example, the second storage circuit **546** can be formed with different storage technologies forming a memory hierarchal system including different levels of caching, main memory, rotating media, or off-line storage.

(127) The second storage circuit **546** can be a controller of a volatile memory, a nonvolatile memory, an internal memory, an external memory, or a combination thereof. For example, the second storage circuit **546** can be a controller of a nonvolatile storage such as non-volatile random-access memory (NVRAM), Flash memory, disk storage, or a volatile storage such as static random access memory (SRAM).

(128) The second storage interface **548** can receive information from the other functional units/circuits or from external sources, or can transmit information to the other functional units/circuits or to external destinations. The external sources and the external destinations refer to sources and destinations external to the second device **106**.

(129) The second storage interface **548** can include different implementations depending on which functional units/circuits or external units/circuits are being interfaced with the second storage circuit **546**. The second storage interface **548** can be implemented with technologies and techniques similar to the implementation of the second control interface **544**. The second storage circuit **546** can receive global re-optimization unit **114** as updates from the first device **102**.

(130) The second communication circuit **536** can enable external communication to and from the second device **106**. For example, the second communication circuit **536** can permit the second device **106** to communicate with the first device **102** over the network **104**. By way of an example, the second device **106** can provide thresholds derived from the optimized parameters **120** to the other vehicles that are in or near the region of interest **203** of the first device **102**.

(131) The second communication circuit **536** can also function as a communication hub allowing the second device **106** to function as part of the network **104** and not limited to be an endpoint or terminal unit or circuit to the network **104**. The second communication circuit **536** can include active and passive circuitry components, such as microelectronics, wireless circuitry, wireline circuitry, analogue circuitry, or an antenna, for interaction with the network **104**.

(132) The second communication circuit **536** can include a second communication interface **550**. The second communication interface **550** can be used for communication between the second communication circuit **536** and other functional units or circuits in the second device **106**. The second communication interface **550** can receive information from the other functional units/circuits or can transmit information to the other functional units or circuits.

(133) The second communication interface **550** can include different implementations depending on which functional units or circuits are being interfaced with the second communication circuit **536**. The second communication interface **550** can be implemented with technologies and

techniques similar to the implementation of the second control interface **544**, including circuitry, waveguides, wireless circuitry, wireline circuitry, analogue circuitry, or a combination thereof.

(134) The second communication circuit **536** can couple with the network **104** to send information to the first device **102**, including the optimized parameters **120** in the second device transmission **510**. The first device **102** can receive information in the first communication circuit **516** from the second device transmission **510** of the network **104**. The navigation system **100** can be executed by the first control circuit **512**, the second control circuit **534**, or a combination thereof. For illustrative purposes, the second device **106** is shown with the partition containing the second user interface **538**, the second storage circuit **546**, the second control circuit **534**, and the second communication circuit **536**, although it is understood that the second device **106** can include a different partition. For example, the second software **542** can be partitioned differently such that some or all of its function can be in the second control circuit **534** and the second communication circuit **536**. Also, the second device **106** can include other functional units or circuits not shown in FIG. 5 for clarity.

(135) The functional units or circuits in the first device **102** can work individually and independently of the other functional units or circuits. The first device **102** can work individually and independently from the second device **106** and the network **104**.

(136) The functional units or circuits in the second device **106** can work individually and independently of the other functional units or circuits. The second device **106** can work individually and independently from the first device **102** and the network **104**.

(137) The functional units or circuits described above can be implemented in hardware. For example, one or more of the functional units or circuits can be implemented using a gate array, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), circuitry, a processor, a computer, integrated circuit, integrated circuit cores, a pressure sensor, an inertial sensor, a microelectromechanical system (MEMS), a passive device, a physical non-transitory memory medium containing instructions for performing the software function, a portion therein, or a combination thereof.

(138) For illustrative purposes, the navigation system **100** is described by operation of the first device **102** and the second device **106**. It is understood that the first device **102** and the second device **106** can operate any of the modules and functions of the navigation system **100**.

(139) By way of a further example, the first device **102** can be the autonomous vehicle or the driver assisted vehicle. The first interface circuit **518** can receive input from the optical sensor **108** of FIG. 1, for compiling the global re-optimization unit **114**. The global re-optimization unit **114** can be generated by the first control circuit **512** from the optical sensor **108** and the first location circuit **520**.

(140) It has been discovered that the second device **106** can receive the optimized parameters **120** from the first device **102** that provides warnings and alerts to vehicles in the area of the region of interest **203**. As an example, the second control circuit **534** can verify the optimized parameters **120** and pass the information to the second storage circuit **546** for analysis.

(141) Referring now to FIG. 6, therein is shown an exemplary operational flow chart **601** of the navigation system **100** of FIG. 1 in an embodiment of the present invention. The exemplary operational flow chart **601** of the navigation system **100** depicts a collect images module **602**, in which the parameter extraction unit **112** of FIG. 1 collects the optical data stream **111** of FIG. 1 from the optical sensors **108** for analysis. The collect images module **602** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** in conjunction with the parameter extraction unit **112** and the front optical sensor **220** of FIG. 2, the rear optical sensor **222** of FIG. 2, the left optical sensor **224** of FIG. 2, and the right optical sensor **226** of FIG. 2. The collect images module **602** collect the optical data stream **111** for all of the optical sensors **108**.

(142) The collect images module **602** can be coupled to an extract line features module **604**. The extract line features module **604** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** of FIG. 5 in conjunction with the parameter extraction unit **112**. The extract line features module **604** can utilize machine learning to extract the lane lines **402** of FIG. 4, the horizontal lines **404** of FIG. 4, and the

vertical lines **406** of FIG. **4** for analysis.

(143) The extract line features module **604** can be coupled to a camera intrinsic parameters calibration module **606**. The camera intrinsic parameters calibration module **606** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** in conjunction with the parameter extraction unit **112**. The camera intrinsic parameters calibration module **606** can utilize the horizontal lines **404** and the vertical lines **406** to calculate the intrinsic parameters **420** including focal length, aspect ratio, the principal point **320**, and the distortion coefficient **412**. Since the focal length and the aspect ratio are fixed at manufacturing, the camera intrinsic parameters calibration module **606** can monitor the principal point **320** and the distortion coefficient **412** as a higher priority. Any rapid deviation from the previous calibrated values can indicate an immanent problem.

(144) The camera intrinsic parameters calibration module **606** can be coupled to a camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **608**. The camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **608** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** in conjunction with the parameter extraction unit **112**. The lane lines **402** can be used to calibrate the extrinsic parameters **418** of FIG. **4** of the front optical sensor **220** and the rear optical sensor **222**. Since the lane lines **402** have the characteristic that they are horizontal in nature and parallel to each other, their geometry can be used to calculate the first set of vanishing points **408** and the second set of vanishing points **410**. The vanishing points can be used to calculate the yaw angle and the pitch angle of the camera **304**. The roll angle of the camera **304** can be calculated based on the lane line width **610** of the lane lines **402**. The lane line width **610** can be the measured width of the painted lane lines **402** provided by a lane line features module **612**. The camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **608** can use the lane line width **610** to calculate the roll angle of the camera **304**.

(145) The lane line features module **612** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** in conjunction with the parameter extraction unit **112**. The lane line features module **612** can determine the lane line width **610** by comparing the pixel count of the lane lines **402** with the pixel count of the space between the lane lines **402**.

(146) The camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **608** can be coupled to a surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610**. The surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** in conjunction with the global re-optimization unit **114** of FIG. **1**. The surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610** can calibrate the extrinsic parameters **418** of the left optical sensor **224** and the right optical sensor **226**. Given the knowledge that the lane lines **402** are parallel with each other, the surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610** can align the lane lines **402** observed by the left optical sensor **224** and the right optical sensor **226** with the lane lines **402** calibrated by the front optical sensor **220** and the rear optical sensor **222** previously. The alignment of the lane lines **402** can provide extrinsic parameters **418** for the left optical sensor **224** and the right optical sensor **226**.

(147) The surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610** can solve for the left and right extrinsic parameters. It is understood that the position/location information used in the analysis of the intrinsic parameters **420** of FIG. **4** and the extrinsic parameters **418** of FIG. **4** are based on the overhead view **414** of FIG. **4** coordinate system. By way of an example, the surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610** can calculate the left extrinsic parameters **418** by:

$$(148) \quad P_{\text{left}} = F(P_{\text{left_img}}, \text{extrinsic}_{\text{left}}, \text{intrinsic}_{\text{left}}) \quad \text{EQ(1)}$$

(149) Where $P_{\text{sub.left}}$ is the position of the left lane line, $P_{\text{sub.left_img}}$ is the location of the left lane line in the optical data stream **111**, $\text{extrinsic}_{\text{sub.left}}$ is the extrinsic parameters **418** of the left optical sensor **224**, $\text{intrinsic}_{\text{sub.left}}$ is the intrinsic parameters **420** of the left optical sensor **224**,

$$(150) \quad L_{\text{front}} = F(L_{\text{front_img}}, \text{extrinsic}_{\text{front}}, \text{intrinsic}_{\text{front}}) \quad \text{EQ(2)}$$

(151) Where $L_{\text{sub.front}}$ is the calibrated location of the lane lines as viewed by the front optical sensor **220**, $L_{\text{sub.front_img}}$ is the calibrated location of the lane lines as viewed in the optical data

stream **1111** of the front optical sensor **220**, extrinsic.sub.front is the extrinsic parameters **418** of the front optical sensor **220**, intrinsic.sub.front is the intrinsic parameters **420** of the front optical sensor **220**,

$$(152) \quad L_{\text{rear}} = F(L_{\text{rear_img}}, \text{extrinsic}_{\text{rear}}, \text{intrinsic}_{\text{rear}}) \quad \text{EQ}(3)$$

(153) Where $L_{\text{sub.rear}}$ is the calibrated location of the lane lines as viewed by the rear optical sensor **222**, $L_{\text{sub.rear_img}}$ is the calibrated location of the lane lines as viewed by the rear optical sensor **222**, $\text{extrinsic.sub.rear}$ is the extrinsic parameters **418** of the rear optical sensor **222**, $\text{intrinsic.sub.rear}$ is the intrinsic parameters **420** of the rear optical sensor **222**,

$$(154) \quad \min = \text{.Math.}_{i=1}^N \text{dis}(\text{Pleft}, L_{\text{front}}, L_{\text{rear}}) \quad \text{EQ}(4)$$

(155) Where the minimize function min of the summation from $i=1$ to N of the distance dis between the position of the left lane line, the calibrated location of the lane lines as viewed by the front optical sensor **220**, and the calibrated location of the lane lines as viewed by the rear optical sensor **222**.

(156) It is understood that the same equation techniques can be employed on the right optical sensor **226** in order to optimize the extrinsic parameters **418** and intrinsic parameters **420** of the right optical sensor **226**.

(157) The surround camera extrinsic parameters calibration module **610** can be coupled to a global re-optimization module **616**. The global re-optimization module **616** can be operated by the first control circuit **512** in conjunction with the global re-optimization unit **114** in order to assign the real world location, such as a GPS location, of the lines and features in the optical data stream for each of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226**. The first control circuit **512** can further utilize the overhead view unit **116** to fuse the images from the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** into the overhead view **414** of FIG. 4. The overhead view **414** can be displayed on the user interface **212** of FIG. 2 having the view center **415** of FIG. 4 at the geolocation of the first device **102**. The relative position of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** to the view center **415** can be determined during the manufacture of the first device **102** in order to provide an absolute location of the overhead view **414**.

(158) The global re-optimization module **616** can be coupled to a utilize optimized parameters module **618**. The utilize optimized parameters module **618** can be operated by the first control circuit **512**. When the calibration of intrinsic parameters **420** and extrinsic parameters **418** of the front optical sensor **220**, the rear optical sensor **222**, the left optical sensor **224**, and the right optical sensor **226** is complete, the optimized parameters **120** can be utilized to generate the overhead view **414** and the optimized parameters **120** can be transferred to the second device **105** of FIG. 1 for analysis. The second device **106** can determine trends in the parameters and set thresholds for warnings of maintenance required and manual intervention required. If the second device **106** receives the optimized parameters **120** that are below the threshold for safe operation of the first device **102**, the optical sensor alert **416** can be sent to the first device **102** for display on the user interface **212**.

(159) It has been discovered that calibration the optimized parameters **120** can maintain the safe operation of the first device **102**, If the optimized parameters **120** fail to meet the safety threshold provided by the second device **106**, the user **118** can be alerted by displaying the optical sensor alert **416** on the user interface **212**. The optical sensor alert **416** can indicate that maintenance is required, but the vehicle can proceed or manual intervention is required because the first device **102** is unsafe to operate in the autonomous mode.

(160) Referring now to FIG. 7, therein is shown a flow chart of a method **700** of operation of a navigation system **100** of FIG. 1 in an embodiment of the present invention. The method **700** includes: capturing a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors in a block **702**: extracting lane

lines from the sensor data stream in a block **704**: optimizing an intrinsic parameter and an extrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines in a block **706**: compiling optimized parameters including the intrinsic parameter and the extrinsic parameter in a block **708**: and receiving an optical sensor alert through the network for displaying on a device in a block **710**.

(161) The resulting method, process, apparatus, device, product, and/or system is straightforward, cost-effective, uncomplicated, highly versatile, accurate, sensitive, and effective, and can be implemented by adapting known components for ready, efficient, and economical manufacturing, application, and utilization. Another important aspect of an embodiment of the present invention is that it valuably supports and services the historical trend of reducing costs, simplifying systems, and increasing performance.

(162) These and other valuable aspects of an embodiment of the present invention consequently further the state of the technology to at least the next level.

(163) While the invention has been described in conjunction with a specific best mode, it is to be understood that many alternatives, modifications, and variations will be apparent to those skilled in the art in light of the foregoing description. Accordingly, it is intended to embrace all such alternatives, modifications, and variations that fall within the scope of the included claims. All matters set forth herein or shown in the accompanying drawings are to be interpreted in an illustrative and non-limiting sense.

Claims

1. A navigation system comprising: a control circuit configured to: capture a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors, extract lane lines, a horizontal line, and a vertical line from the sensor data stream, determine a distortion coefficient of the sensor data stream from a principal point, the lane lines, a first set of vanishing points of the horizontal line, and a second set of vanishing points of the vertical line, wherein the principal point is located at an intersection of the horizontal line connecting the first set of vanishing points and the vertical line connecting the second set of vanishing points, optimize an extrinsic parameter and an intrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines and the distortion coefficient, and compile optimized parameters including the extrinsic parameter and the intrinsic parameter; and a communication circuit, coupled to the control circuit, configured to receive an optical sensor alert, when the optimized parameters are below a threshold, for displaying on a device.
2. The system as claimed in claim 1 wherein the control circuit is configured to calculate the distortion coefficient includes the control circuit is configured to: determine the principal point for an image plane; calculate a distance between the principal point and the lane lines; and monitor a curvature of the lane lines by correcting the alignment of lane line ends, in an overhead view, of images from the front optical sensor and left optical sensor.
3. The system as claimed in claim 1 wherein the control circuit is configured to calculate the distortion coefficient based on the extracting the lane lines, the horizontal lines, and the vertical lines from the sensor data stream.
4. The system as claimed in claim 1 wherein the control circuit is configured to generate the first set of vanishing points and the second set of vanishing points to calculate the distortion coefficient.
5. The system as claimed in claim 1 wherein the control circuit is configured to execute a global re-optimization module including generating an overhead view.
6. The system as claimed in claim 1 wherein the control circuit is configured to generate an overhead view by combining the sensor data stream from a front optical sensor, a rear optical sensor, a left optical sensor, and a right optical sensor and correcting the overlap regions.
7. The system as claimed in claim 1 wherein the control circuit is configured to calculate the extrinsic parameter of a front optical sensor and a rear optical sensor based on a lane line width.
8. A method of operation for a navigation system comprising: capturing a sensor data stream

provided by optical sensors; extracting lane lines, a horizontal line, and a vertical line from the sensor data stream; determining a distortion coefficient of the sensor data stream from a principal point, the lane lines, a first set of vanishing points of the horizontal line, and a second set of vanishing points of the vertical line, wherein the principal point is located at an intersection of the horizontal line connecting the first set of vanishing points and the vertical line connecting the second set of vanishing points; optimizing an extrinsic parameter and an intrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines and the distortion coefficient; compiling optimized parameters including the extrinsic parameter and the intrinsic parameter; and receiving an optical sensor alert, when the optimized parameters are below a threshold, for displaying on a device.

9. The method as claimed in claim 8 further comprising calculating the distortion coefficient by determining the principal point for an image plane and calculating a distance between the principal point and the lane lines includes monitoring a curvature of the lane lines by correcting the alignment of lane line ends, in an overhead view, of images from the front optical sensor and left optical sensor.

10. The method as claimed in claim 8 further comprising calculating the distortion coefficient by extracting the lane lines, the horizontal lines, and the vertical lines from the sensor data stream.

11. The method as claimed in claim 8 further comprising generating the first set of vanishing points and the second set of vanishing points to calculate the distortion coefficient.

12. The method as claimed in claim 8 further comprising executing a global re-optimization module including generating an overhead view.

13. The method as claimed in claim 8 further comprising generating an overhead view by combining the sensor data stream from a front optical sensor, a rear optical sensor, a left optical sensor, and a right optical sensor and correcting the overlap regions.

14. The method as claimed in claim 8 further comprising calculating the extrinsic parameter of a front optical sensor and a rear optical sensor based on a lane line width.

15. A non-transitory computer readable medium including instructions for a navigation system comprising: capturing a sensor data stream provided by optical sensors; extracting lane lines, a horizontal line, and a vertical line from the sensor data stream; determining a distortion coefficient of the sensor data stream from a principal point, the lane lines, a first set of vanishing points of the horizontal line, and a second set of vanishing points of the vertical line, wherein the principal point is located at an intersection of the horizontal line connecting the first set of vanishing points and the vertical line connecting the second set of vanishing points; optimizing an extrinsic parameter and an intrinsic parameter based on the extract of the lane lines and the distortion coefficient; compiling optimized parameters including the extrinsic parameter and the intrinsic parameter; and receiving an optical sensor alert, when the optimized parameters are below a threshold, for displaying on a device.

16. The non-transitory computer readable medium including the instructions as claimed in claim 15 further comprising calculating the distortion coefficient by determining the principal point for an image plane and calculating a distance between the principal point and the lane lines includes monitoring a curvature of the lane lines by correcting the alignment of lane line ends, in an overhead view, of images from the front optical sensor and left optical sensor.

17. The non-transitory computer readable medium including the instructions as claimed in claim 15 further comprising calculating the distortion coefficient by extracting the lane lines, the horizontal lines, and the vertical lines from the sensor data stream.

18. The non-transitory computer readable medium including the instructions as claimed in claim 15 further comprising executing a global re-optimization module including generating an overhead view.

19. The non-transitory computer readable medium including the instructions as claimed in claim 15 further comprising generating an overhead view by combining the sensor data stream from a front optical sensor, a rear optical sensor, a left optical sensor, and a right optical sensor and correcting

the overlap regions.

20. The non-transitory computer readable medium including the instructions as claimed in claim 15 further comprising calculating the extrinsic parameter of a front optical sensor and a rear optical sensor based on a lane line width.
